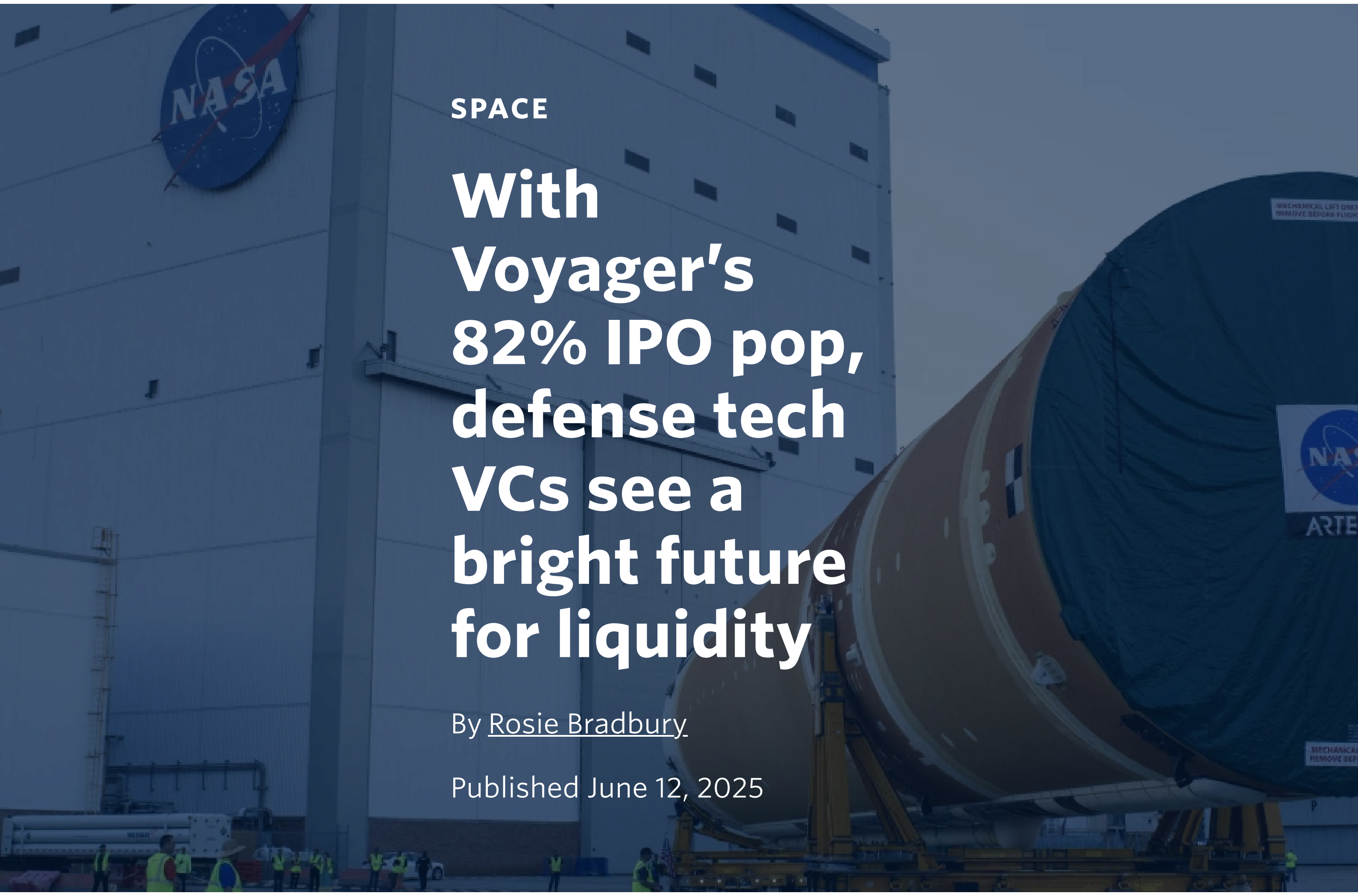


SPACE

With Voyager's 82% IPO pop, defense tech VCs see a bright future for liquidity

By Rosie Bradbury

Published June 12, 2025

Voyager closed its first day trading on the New York Stock Exchange at $56.48 per share, giving it an 82% pop from its IPO price.

The latest VC-backed IPO is a temperature check for **the hottest sector in venture** outside of AI: defense tech.

Voyager Technologies, a software provider for space and defense technology companies, priced its IPO at $31 per share on Tuesday night, setting a fully diluted market cap of $1.9 billion.

Voyager is an unusual IPO candidate in this period of illiquidity for venture: It's still unprofitable; it's relatively young, having been founded in 2019; and more than 80% of its $144.2 million in revenue in 2024 came from US government work. Voyager's single biggest customer, NASA, accounted for over 25% of its revenue last year.

It's also growing at a slower pace than venture investors typically look for: Voyager's net sales grew 6% year-over-year between 2023 and 2024.

Its performance in the public markets will set the tone for other defense and space tech companies that have major government contracts as a significant portion of their funding.

Despite its risks, Voyager's IPO terms are actually a significant premium from its last known valuation. Backed by investors including Midway Venture Partners, Hemisphere Ventures and Gaingels, its Series A in early 2023 set its post-money valuation at $680 million, according to PitchBook data.

Notably, none of its backers are listed in its regulatory documents as having at least a 5% stake in the company prior to the IPO.

"It bodes well for new companies who can track a venture path against the Voyager multiple," said Ross Fubini, managing partner and defense tech investor at XYZ Venture Capital.

A strong performance in the public market has the potential to clear a path for more defense tech companies like Anduril and Shield AI, which have been raking in capital from VCs.

Unlike asset-light software brands, defense tech companies are incentivized to go public so they can access larger pools of capital and compete with legacy defense contractors.

On Tuesday, Anduril CEO Palmer Luckey said that Anduril would “definitely” go public at some point. The company recently announced a $2.5 billion funding round at a $30.5 billion valuation.

Mark Felix/Getty Images

Learn more about our editorial standards.

About Rosie Bradbury

Rosie Bradbury is a senior reporter covering startups and venture capital for PitchBook News. Based in New York, she previously reported for the Bureau of Investigative Journalism, Business Insider and Wired. Rosie studied history and politics at the University of Cambridge.

Share:

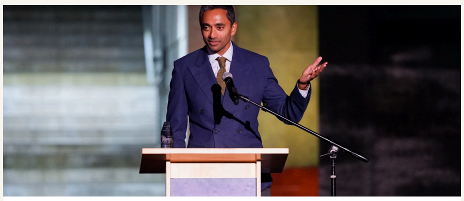
Tags: Space IPO Venture Capital

Related content

PE EXITS

5 charts: Traditional PE exits may be reopening—but mainly in North America

August 19, 2025



FEATURED

‘SPAC King’ Chamath Palihapitiya is back with a new one

August 18, 2025

IPO

Blockchain-based lender Figure files for IPO

August 18, 2025

Europe lagged behind North America in all three routes.

The American Exceptionalism Acquisition Corp. will focus on energy, AI, decentralized finance...

The company has been profitable since 2024.

Load More